Edit article
View stats
View post

Kelee Petzelt

The True Fight for Health and Dignity in a Flawed System

Kelee Petzelt
Advocate for Change | Driving AI to Empower Pharmacists as Healthcare Leaders | Transforming Patient Care with a Focus...

September 24, 2024

In healthcare, we find inspiration in underdog stories—tales that reflect resilience, courage, and an unyielding desire to survive against overwhelming odds. These are not just stories of patients battling illness; they are stories of people fighting for their health *and* their dignity within a healthcare system that often feels like an obstacle in itself. From navigating endless paperwork to being denied life-saving treatments over technicalities, these individuals refuse to be victims of a flawed system.

It's heartbreaking to realize how much of their energy goes into overcoming bureaucratic barriers. Every victory—whether a medication is finally approved or a treatment becomes accessible—feels like a win not just for their health, but for their dignity. They are not just battling illness; they are also fighting to be seen, heard, and treated with the respect and care they deserve. These healthcare heroes are driven by the desire to live, to overcome, and to not be defined by the roadblocks put in their way.

We need to truly hear their stories. These patients shouldn't have to fight for both their lives *and* their dignity in a system that is supposed to protect them. The system shouldn't force them through loops of denials and delays, stripping away their sense of worth in the process. Yet, time and time again, we see that they do not let these hardships break them. Instead, they dig deep, using hope and compassion as their fuel to keep going.

Bianca Sparacino beautifully captures this sentiment: “The kindest people are not born that way, they are made. They are the ones that have experienced so much at the hands of life, they are the ones who have dug themselves out of the dark... they choose to believe in goodness, because they have seen firsthand why compassion is so necessary."

These healthcare underdogs embody this spirit. They have every reason to harden, yet they choose kindness, resilience, and compassion. Their fight is not just for survival, but for dignity in a system that makes their journey harder than it needs to be. They’re fighting for their lives—they shouldn’t have to fight for their dignity and access to quality healthcare, too.

Let’s listen to them, learn from their stories, and build a healthcare system where the battle is only with illness—not with the very system that’s supposed to be helping them heal.

Comments

20 · 4 comments

Like Comment Share

Add a comment...

Most recent

Ksenja Vista • 1st 7mo
Helping E-commerce with Fulfillment | Warehousing and Cross-dockin...

Kelee, how is it going?

Like | Reply

Karen Silverblatt Nameth • 2nd (edited) 7mo
Vice President Business Development, Pharmacy, Inovalon| Me...

Kelee, you may struggle, but never alone - you have an army of us who have your back! Can't wait to see you in Nashville next week, we will have fun. Invaryant is very lucky to have you on their team!

Love · 4 | Reply · 2 replies

See previous replies

Kelee Petzelt Author (edited) 7mo
Advocate for Change | Driving AI to Empower Pharmacis...

Karen Silverblatt Nameth Do I need my glow in the dark hat?

Like | Reply | 47 impressions

Kelee Petzelt

Advocate for Change | Driving AI to Empower Pharmacists as Healthcare Leaders | Transforming Patient Care with a Focus on the Future | Champion for Patient-Centered Innovation and Precision Medicine

More articles for you

Published on LinkedIn

Families Being Recognized as Important Partners in Care

Jill Adolphe, FPCC

9

Published on LinkedIn

Problems obtaining nhs continuing care?

Bob Evans

2

New Bill Boosts Critical Access Hospitals

Paul Lee

13